

Book Cart

A two-player cooperative teaching game · Six shared actions · v1.0

Goal and result

Unload both books at the reading corner within six actions. After each action, first check delivery: if both books are delivered, both players immediately win. Otherwise, both lose after action six. There are no individual points.

Setup

1. Use the route on page 2, one cart marker, two book markers, and one action counter. Drawing the board and using coins or paper pieces also works.
2. Put the cart at Depot 0, both books in the depot holding area, and the counter at 0. Cargo and delivered areas start empty. Capacity is two books. All information is public.
3. A acts first; A and B alternate controlling the same cart. Discussion is allowed, but the active player decides. If someone helps move pieces, the active player confirms the chosen action.

Choose one legal action each turn

Action	Requirement and effect
Load 1 book	At Depot 0, with a book waiting and spare capacity: put one book aboard.
Move 1 space	Move the cart to an adjacent location. 0 connects to 1; 1 connects to 2. Travel works both ways.
Unload 1 book	At Reading Corner 2, with a book aboard: move exactly one to the delivered area.
Wait 1 action	Leave all pieces where they are, but still spend one action.

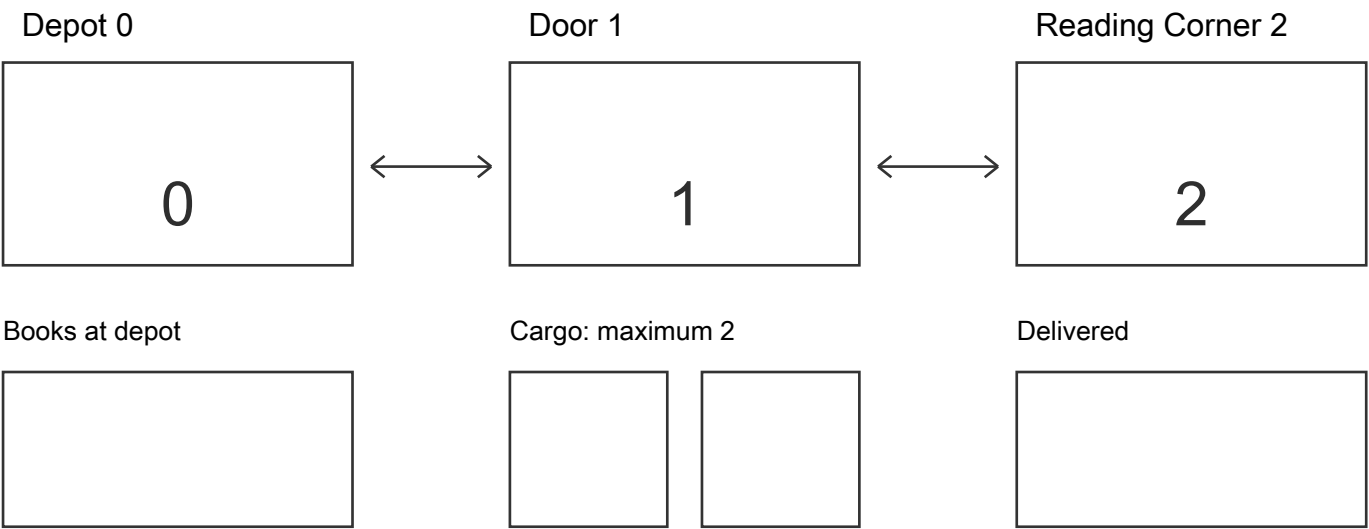
Act, count, check

After the action, advance the counter one space and check win then loss as above. Pass control only if the game continues. Reselect an unavailable action without spending an action. Movement never loads or unloads automatically. Load only at the depot and unload only at the corner; delivered books cannot be collected again. There are no random events, loans, or extra actions.

This game is separate from the main river-crossing example. Its narrow scheduling puzzle supports rule comparisons and observation; being runnable does not establish replayability or suitability for every reader.

Board, markers, and record

Monochrome printing is sufficient. Cut out the four markers below or use your own pieces. Books 1 and 2 have identical rules. Scaling the print changes component sizes.



Actions used: start at 0; advance once after every action

0	1	2	3	4	5	6
Start	A	B	A	B	A	B

Optional record: write the actions and states that occurred

Action	Choice	Cart at	Cargo	Delivered
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				

Cut along the boxes. Each book occupies one cargo space.



Change one rule: unload all

Reset to the starting position. Replace only “Unload 1 book” with “At the reading corner, with cargo aboard, spend one action to unload all books aboard.” Keep setup, loading, movement, waiting, capacity, the six-action deadline, and ending order unchanged.

Action	Base: unload one	Variant: unload all
1	Load one; cargo 1	Load one; cargo 1
2	Load another; cargo 2	Load another; cargo 2
3	Move to Door 1; cargo 2	Move to Door 1; cargo 2
4	Move to Corner 2; cargo 2	Move to Corner 2; cargo 2
5	Unload one; delivered 1, cargo 1	Unload both; delivered 2, win now
6	Unload one; delivered 2, win now	Game already ended; no action

What does this result establish?

The base needs at least two loads, two moves, and two unloads: six actions. The variant needs two loads, two moves, and one unload: five. The traces attain both lower bounds.

The variant removes one unload and B's former sixth action. Faster completion does not automatically mean more enjoyment or participation. No human playtest result is claimed.

Check, with answers

The second book is unloaded on action six in the base game. Win or lose? Win: check completed delivery before applying the deadline to an incomplete position. Does arriving at the corner deliver a book? No; unloading still requires an action.